

Presenting this evidence with the initial application can be helpful as it will provide a more complete history of the tree. If no evidence is presented it may result in the refusal of the application.

Tree Replacement

To maintain urban tree canopy cover, when a Vegetation Clearing Permit is granted to clear vegetation, the applicant may be required to replace the vegetation with an advanced approved species which is to be established on their property and maintained to maturity. Where there is insufficient space for replanting advanced vegetation the applicant may provide offset planting on public land. This may be undertaken by entering into a deed of agreement with Council. Generally, for every tree removed, the replacement of three (3) off-site trees will be required with pot size dependent on the canopy spread of the tree(s) to be removed as assessed by Council. Audit checks of replacement planting will be carried out by Council. Refer to Part 3.2.4.

Arborist and Other Specialist Reports

Supporting evidence for the removal or pruning of a tree/s may require a report from a consulting arborist (AQF Level 5) where there is insufficient evidence to support the removal of a tree as assessed against the above criteria. Council may request the applicant to provide an arborist's report for more complex tree assessments such as an aerial inspection; root mapping or identification; fungal or pest problems; or internal diagnostic assessment.

Further supporting evidence may also be required from a structural engineer or licensed plumber if buildings or underground services are affected. Details of requirements for arborist and other specialist reports are listed in the appendices of the WTMG.

3.1.3 Trees considered to pose an imminent danger

- (a) Except for specified emergency situations, expert advice should always be obtained with respect to hazardous trees to confirm their condition.
- (b) Where a hazardous tree is removed (in an emergency situation) due to obvious instability or hazard (e.g. following a storm), Council's Tree Management must be notified prior to removal. It is recommended that evidence of the tree's condition be retained for a period of at least six (6) months after the event and produced at Council's request if needed. Such evidence might include a:
 - (i) Report by a consulting arborist including photographs; and/or
 - (ii) Written statement from the State Emergency Services, if the Service carried out the emergency work at the owner's request.
- (c) If trees are removed for the above reasons it is a requirement to plant replacement trees of a suitable native species to maintain canopy cover in Waverley. Refer to Part 3.1.4.

3.2 LANDSCAPING

Objectives

- (a) To enhance the amenity and visual setting of the site, streetscape, and surrounding neighbourhood.